



English for the Profession

Business Writing

Week 3: The Writing Process, Sentence
Construction, and Paragraph Development

Every successful business document begins with an effective writing process.





Explain the stages of the writing process and apply them to professional documents.



Construct effective sentences using correct structure, variety, and clarity.



Develop coherent paragraphs with unity, transitions, and strong supporting ideas.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to identify and apply each stage of the professional writing process — from prewriting and drafting to revising, editing, and publishing — to produce clear and purposeful business documents.

You will also recognize common sentence errors such as fragments, run-ons, and comma splices, and learn how to correct them to strengthen your written communication.

Icebreaker



Decode this message:

"send report tomorrow maybe before meeting thanks"

What does the sender really mean? What information is missing?



What does the sender really mean?



What information is missing from this message?



Professional writing should never make readers guess.



Why Business Writing Matters

✉ Email A (Vague):

"Send the report ASAP."

✉ Email B (Professional):

"Good morning, Ana. Kindly submit the quarterly sales report by 3:00 PM today so we can include it in tomorrow's management meeting. Thank you."

💬 Which email would you rather receive?

Clarity builds professionalism and effectiveness. Effective business writing removes ambiguity, respects the reader's time, and communicates purpose with precision.



Characteristics of Effective Business Writing



Clear: Avoid ambiguity.

Before: "Please send the thing ASAP."

After: "Please send the sales report by 3:00 PM today."



Clear & Concise: Say exactly what you mean using only the words you need.

Concise: Remove unnecessary words.

Before: "Due to the fact that we are currently experiencing..."

After: "Because we are experiencing..."



Correct & Coherent: Use accurate grammar and organize ideas with logical flow.

Correct: Use proper grammar and spelling.

Coherent: Arrange ideas in a logical, connected order so readers follow your message easily.

Courteous: Maintain a respectful, professional tone in all written communication.



Courteous: Use a respectful and professional tone in every document.



The Writing Process

Every professional document follows a structured path from idea to final output. The writing process consists of five key stages:

Prewriting → Drafting → Revising → Editing → Publishing

Each stage plays a critical role in producing clear, accurate, and effective business communication. Skipping any stage—especially revising and editing—often results in weak, unclear, or error-filled writing that undermines your professional credibility.

💡 Think About It: "Which stage do you usually skip?"

Most writers rush through revision and editing, yet these stages transform a rough draft into polished, professional writing. Revising improves your ideas and structure; editing corrects grammar, spelling, and punctuation. Together, they elevate the quality of any business document—from a simple email to a formal report.



Prewriting

Your supervisor asks you to prepare a proposal for Employee Wellness Week. Before you write a single word, ask yourself these key questions to plan your document effectively.



Who is the audience?
(Employees, HR,
management?)



What is the objective? (Inform,
persuade, request approval?)



What information is needed?
(Budget, schedule, benefits
data?)



Drafting:

Embrace Imperfection

FIRST DRAFT

"The wellness program is good. It helps employees. They feel better. The company also benefits from it."

IMPROVED DRAFT

"Implementing an Employee Wellness Program significantly improves staff morale and productivity. When employees feel supported, they perform more effectively, reducing absenteeism and fostering a positive workplace culture."

Key Takeaway: First drafts are not final — focus on getting your ideas down first, then refine them through revision.



Revising:

Improving Ideas

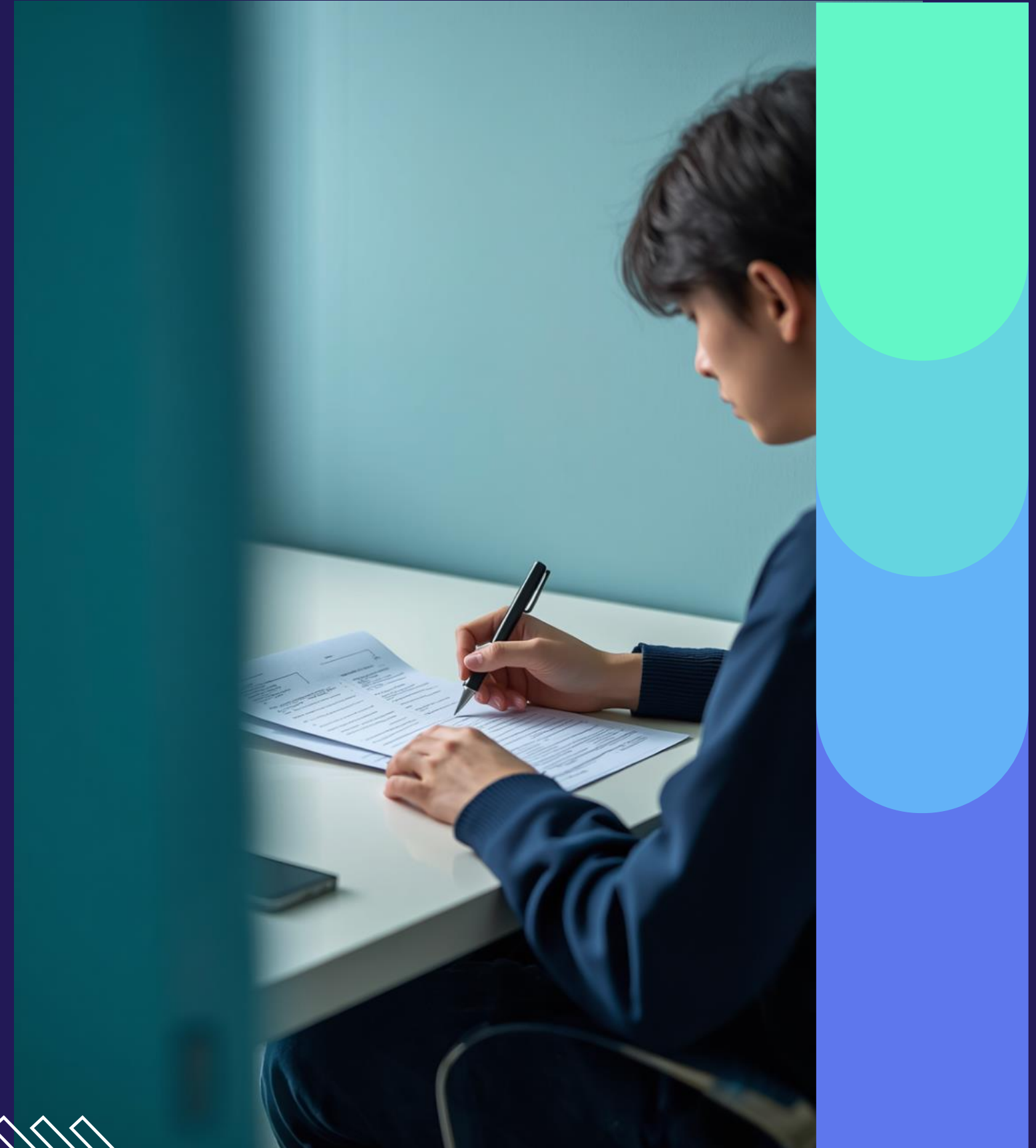
X Original:

"The meeting was good because many ideas."

✓ Revised:

"The meeting was productive because participants shared many innovative ideas."

Revision improves clarity and depth — it strengthens your message, not just fixes errors. Always ask: Is my meaning clear? Is my sentence complete?



Editing: Spot the Mistakes



Read the email excerpt below. Find the mistakes in capitalization, punctuation, and grammar. Be ready to explain each error and suggest the correct version.

"Dear Sir I am applying for the position in your company. I seen your job posting online and I think I am qualify for this role. Please find attach my resume. thank you for your time."



Task: Identify 3 errors — capitalization, punctuation, and grammar mistakes are hidden in the excerpt above.



Hint: Look for missing punctuation after a greeting, incorrect verb forms, and lowercase where capitals are required.



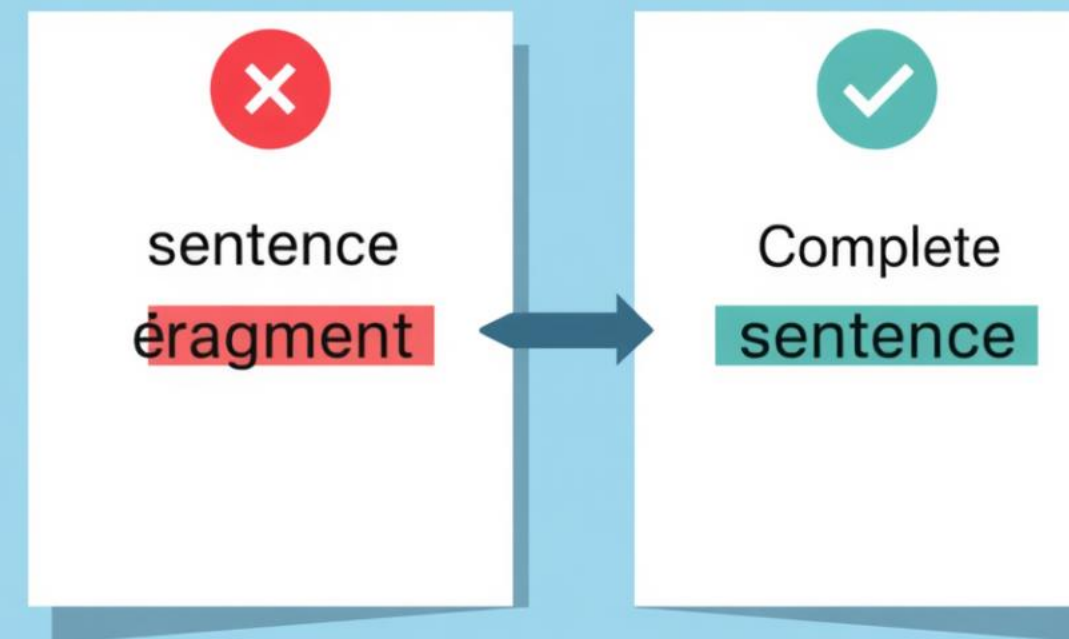
Sentence Construction:

Fragment or Complete?

✗ Fragment:
"Because the manager approved."

Is this sentence complete or incomplete?
A fragment is missing a subject, a verb, or a complete thought — even if it looks like a sentence.

✓ Corrected:
"Because the manager approved, we can proceed with the project."
Key Rule: Every sentence must express a complete thought with a subject and a predicate.





Fragments

Incomplete thoughts that cannot stand alone as a sentence.

✗ "Because the manager approved."

✓ "Because the manager approved, we can proceed with the project."



Run-On Sentences

Two or more independent clauses joined without proper punctuation.

✗ "She submitted the report he reviewed it immediately."

✓ "She submitted the report, and he reviewed it immediately."



Comma Splices

Two independent clauses incorrectly joined with only a comma.

✗ "The deadline is today, we must finish the proposal."

✓ "The deadline is today; we must finish the proposal."

Common Sentence Errors

Recognizing and correcting sentence errors is essential for professional business writing. Fragments leave readers with incomplete information, run-on sentences create confusion by merging ideas without clear boundaries, and comma splices disrupt the logical flow of your message.

Each of these errors weakens your credibility as a professional communicator. Readers may misinterpret your intent or lose confidence in your writing skills.

Quick Fix Guide: Review every sentence and ask — Does it have a subject? Does it have a verb? Does it express a complete thought? If the answer to any of these is "no," revise before sending. Always proofread your business documents carefully to eliminate these common errors and ensure your writing is clear, correct, and professional.

Sentence

Variety



Varying your sentence structure keeps business writing clear, engaging, and professional. A mix of simple, compound, and complex sentences improves readability and demonstrates writing maturity.

Using only one sentence type makes writing feel repetitive. Skilled business writers combine all three types to maintain reader interest and communicate ideas with precision.



Simple: "The manager approved the budget."
One subject + one predicate. Direct and clear.



Compound: "The manager approved the budget, and the team started working."
Two independent clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction.



Complex: "Because the manager approved the budget, the team started working immediately."
An independent clause joined with a dependent clause for added depth.

Paragraph

Development

✗ Poor Paragraph:

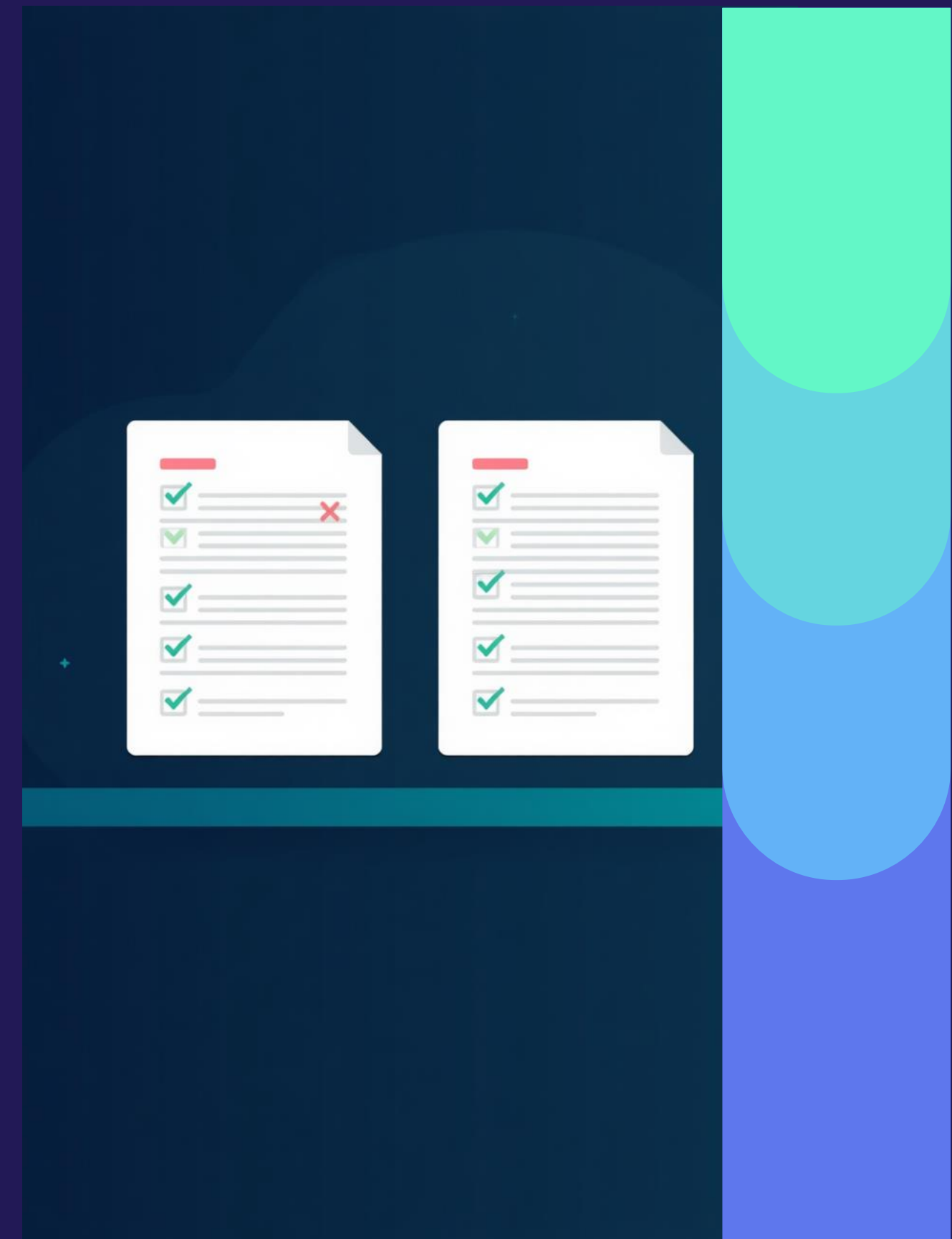
"Communication is important. It helps. Business needs it. Employees work together."

✓ Strong Paragraph:

"Effective communication is essential in the workplace because it fosters collaboration and drives productivity. When employees clearly express ideas and actively listen, teams can solve problems more efficiently and meet organizational goals."

💡 What is missing in the poor paragraph?

- Unity: All sentences must support one main idea.
- Coherence: Ideas must flow logically.
- Development: Support with details and explanation.

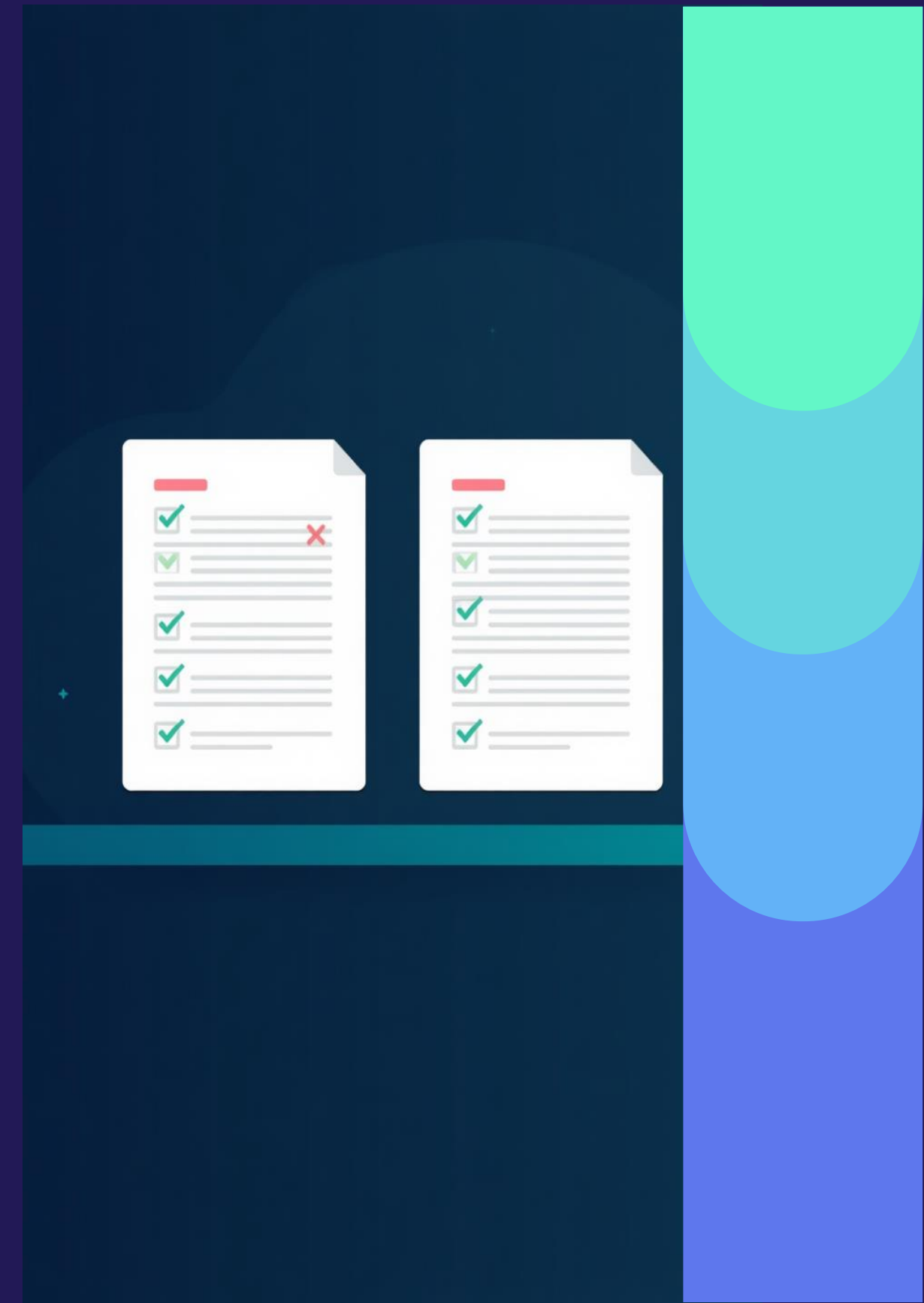


Paragraph Development

The "MEAL" Framework for Perfect Paragraphs

To write strong paragraphs consistently, structure them using these four steps:

- M - Main Idea: State the central point of the paragraph in your very first sentence.
- E - Evidence: Provide a fact, statistic, or specific example that proves your main idea.
- A - Analysis: Explain why the evidence matters or how it links back to your main point.
- L - Lead-Out: Wrap up the thought and transition smoothly into the next paragraph.



Academic vs Professional Writing

🎓 Academic Writing:

"The utilization of effective communicative strategies in organizational contexts has been demonstrated to yield significant improvements in collaborative outcomes among stakeholders."

💼 Professional Writing:

"Using clear communication strategies helps teams collaborate more effectively and achieve better results."

📌 Key Differences:

- Audience: Professors vs. Colleagues/Clients
- Purpose: Demonstrate knowledge vs. Inform & persuade
- Tone: Formal/complex vs. Direct/concise
- Style: Passive, lengthy vs. Active, brief

Discussion: How does knowing your audience change the way you write?



Activity 1: Sentence Paragraph Rescue

Imagine you are an intern assigned to review a coworker's draft before it is sent to a manager. Your task is to **revise three sentences and two paragraphs** to improve clarity, grammar, organization, coherence, and professionalism.

As you revise, remember the writing process:

- **Revise** for ideas, clarity, and organization.
- **Edit** for grammar, punctuation, spelling, and sentence structure.
- The activity will be posted in the MS Teams





Activity 1: Sentence Paragraph Rescue

Sentence 1. I am writing because I want apply in your company because I think I am hardworking and responsible person.

Sentence 2. We finish the proposal yesterday but there is many mistakes and the client not happy.

Paragrph 1. I want to apply in your company because I need experience and I am hardworking. I can do many things and I am willing to learn because I want improve my skills. I hope you choose me because I really need this opportunity and I promise I do my best always.

Paragraph 2. Our company have many employees and communication is important because people need to understand each other. Sometimes employees don't know what to do because the instructions is confusing and many mistakes happen. Good communication help the company become successful and everyone happy.



Performance Task

Career Ready: Write Your Cover Letter Scenario

You recently found an internship or entry-level job that matches your college program. The Human Resources Manager requires applicants to submit a professional cover letter together with their résumé.

Your task is to prepare a one-page cover letter that introduces yourself, explains your interest in the position, and highlights your qualifications.



Performance Task:

A cover letter is a one-page business document sent together with a résumé or curriculum vitae (CV) when applying for a job. It introduces the applicant, highlights relevant qualifications, explains interest in the position, and persuades the employer to grant an interview.

Unlike a résumé, which lists qualifications, a cover letter tells the story behind those qualifications and explains why the applicant is the best fit for the job.



The Header:

Your contact info + the employer's contact info

JANE DOE

jane.doe@gmail.com

+1 234 567 8910

The Greeting:

A personalized salutation (avoid - "To Whom It May Concern")

June 16, 2024

Jane doe,
ABCXYZ
Irxaxa, CA XX099

Dear [Hiring Manager Name],

The Opening Paragraph:

Your attention-grabbing introduction

I am writing to express my enthusiastic interest in the [Job Title] position at [Company Name]. My background in [Your Field] and proven track record of [Your Accomplishments] align seamlessly with the requirements outlined in your job posting.

The Body:

1-2 paragraphs selling your skills and passion

In [Year], I embarked on an entrepreneurial journey, launching [Your Business Name]. This venture allowed me to gain invaluable hands-on experience in [Specific Skills Gained], such as [List Skills]. While the business ultimately didn't achieve the desired outcome, the lessons learned, and skills acquired during this time have significantly strengthened my abilities and fueled my passion for [Your Field].

I am particularly drawn to [Company Name]'s commitment to [Company Values or Mission]. My experience in [Specific Skill] directly translates to your need for [Company Need]. For example, at [Your Business Name], I successfully [Your Accomplishment], demonstrating my ability to [Skill Demonstrated].

I am confident that my unique blend of [Your Skills] and entrepreneurial mindset will make me a valuable asset to your team. I am eager to contribute my skills and experience to [Company Name]'s continued success.

The Closing:

A strong finish with a call to action

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my qualifications can benefit your organization.

The Sign-off:

A professional signature

Sincerely,
[Your Name]